



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Anahat, Abhay clinch titles



Defending champion Anahat Singh overcame stiff resistance and recovered from the brink of defeat to beat Akanksha Salunkhe 11-9, 5-11, 6-11, 13-11, 11-8 in the women's final of the 80th HCL National Squash Championship at the Bombay Gymkhana. In the men's final, Abhay Singh beat defending champion and top seed Velavan Senthilkumar 12-10, 6-11, 11-4, 10-12, 11-4. Akhilesh Kumar beat Saurabh Kumar 11-4, 11-7, 8-11, 2-11, 12-10 to emerge champion in the pro-coach event that fetched a prize of Rs. 50,000. The runner-up got Rs. 30,000.

The prizes were presented by Mrs. Kiran Nadar, the trustee of the Shiv Nadar Foundation, and athlete Shaili Singh.

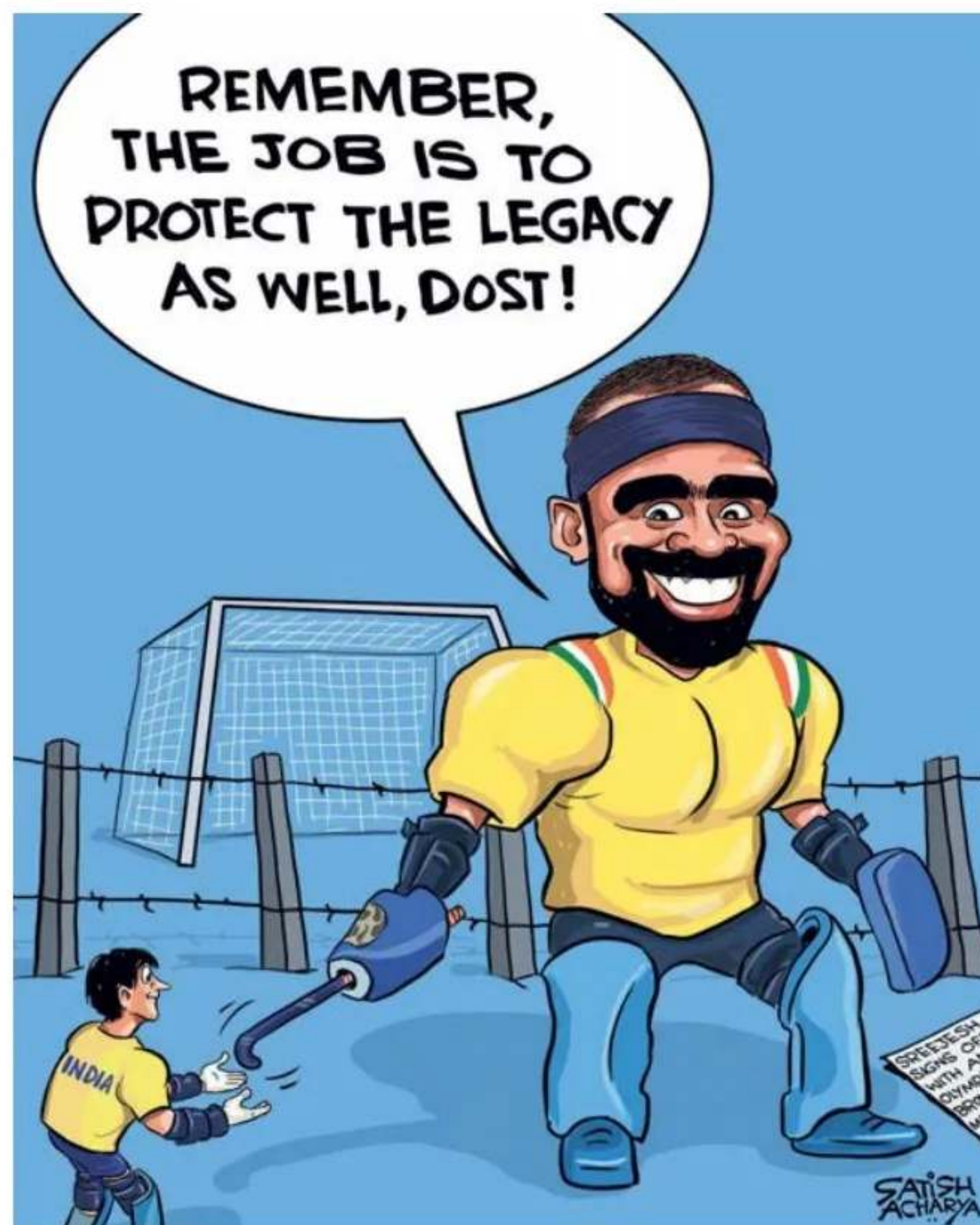
"We are setting a new benchmark with every tournament. This time with a record 670 participants, we are thrilled to see the growing popularity of squash," said Rajat Chandolia, the head of brand HCL.

"We congratulate the winners and thank HCL for their unwavering support in promoting squash. This partnership has been instrumental in fostering talent, encouraging inclusivity and taking Indian squash to new heights," said Cyrus Poncha, the secretary general of the Squash Racquets Federation of India (SRFI).

TEAM SPORTSTAR

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



Winning ways: Darshan Veeraraghavan, who won the 34th MGC-Sportstar Open golf for the 10th time, receives the trophy from Ayon Sengupta, Editor, Sportstar, at the Madras Gymkhana Club in Chennai. P. Krishnan, golf captain (right), and Sanjay Shroff, president MGC (left), are also seen. R. RAGU